

DOCUMENTATION

Who are under-trial prisoners and what problems do they face?

Under-trial prisoners (UTPs) are those who are awaiting trial, or are in trial, awaiting verdict. Over 75% of India's prison population is under-trial.

Problem Outline

The lack of access to legal counsel and proper legal assistance for individuals awaiting trial provides a major hindrance in the Indian judicial system.

- Overcrowding in Indian prisons poses a prominent concern, necessitating immediate attention and reform within the criminal justice system.
- Insufficient judges and under-trial prisoners' difficulty attending court hearings cause delays in delivering verdicts, highlighting the need for more judges and better access to legal proceedings for timely case resolution.
- While Article 39A mandates legal representation for undertrial prisoners, a key challenge is ensuring they have effective access to legal counsel.
- Economically disadvantaged and illiterate individuals encounter significant obstacles in accessing legal resources, highlighting the imperative for focused efforts to bridge this accessibility gap and ensure justice for marginalized populations.

Introduction To Our Solution

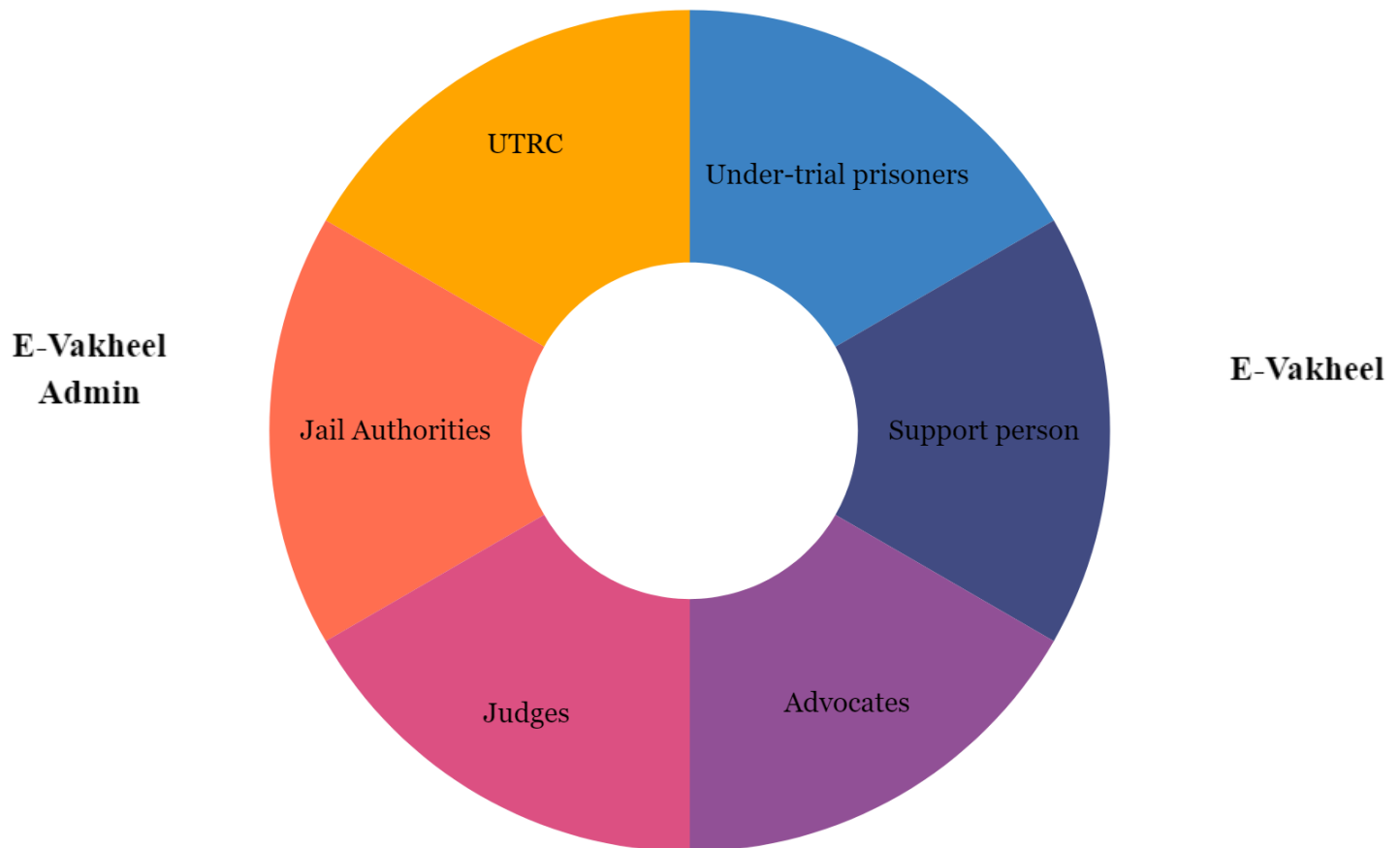
Our solution is a comprehensive mobile application E-Vakheel, with multiple features to help digitalize the judicial process and increase its efficiency, with main focus on under-trial prisoners.

The application contains two instances:

1. E-Vakheel - this will be used by under-trial prisoners, support persons and advocates
2. E-Vakheel Admin - this will be used by judges, under-trial review committee (UTRC), jail authorities

Target audience:

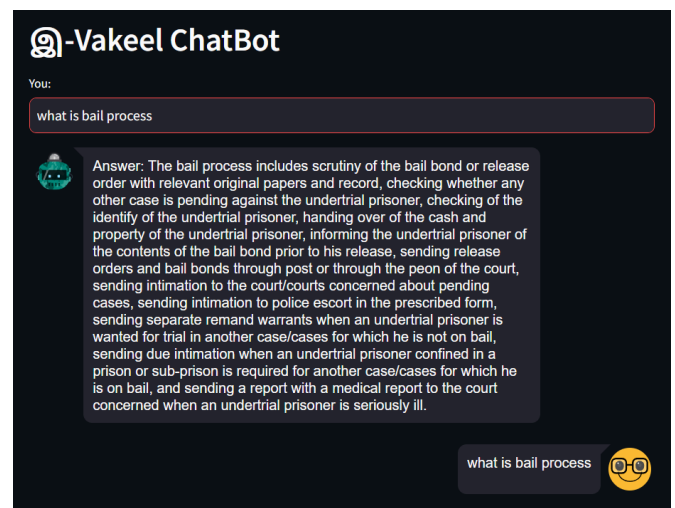
The application has 6 main users:



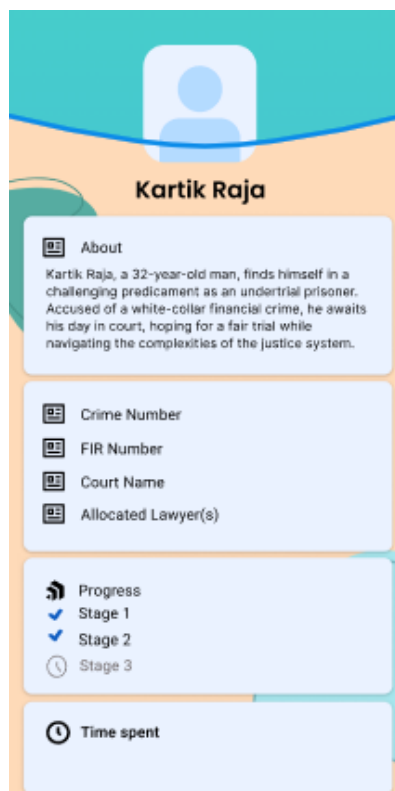
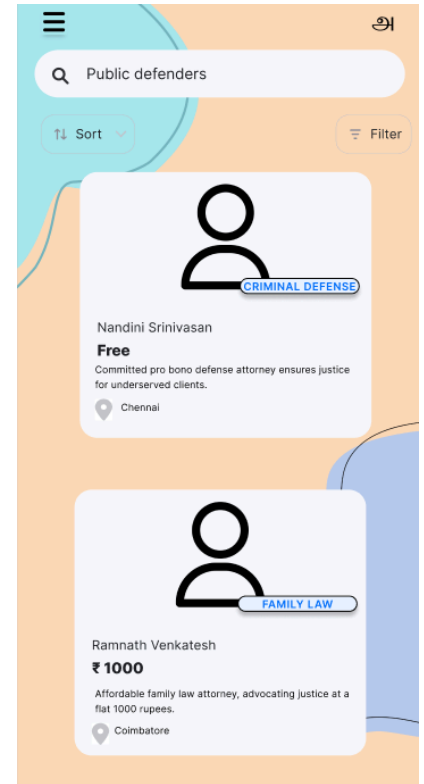
Features Of Our App:

E-Vakheel

- Direct Communication - Under-trial prisoners and support persons can access a list of lawyers and schedule appointments with any one of them. Appropriate filters can be applied to help with the choice



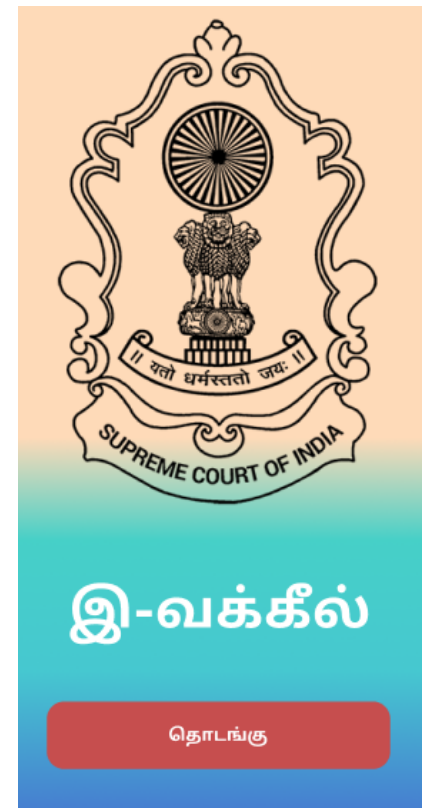
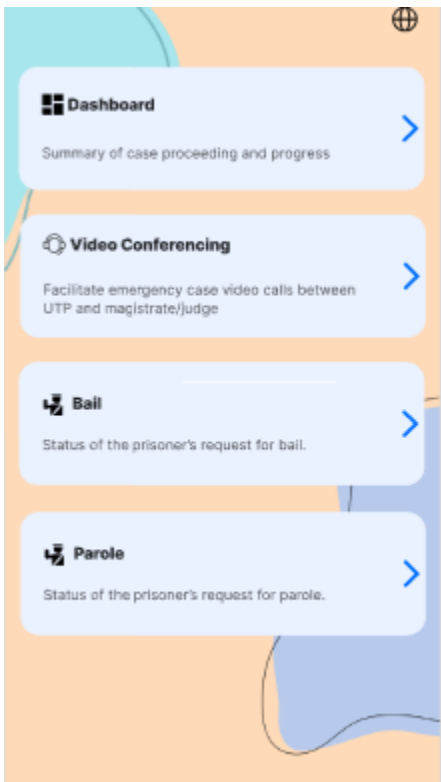
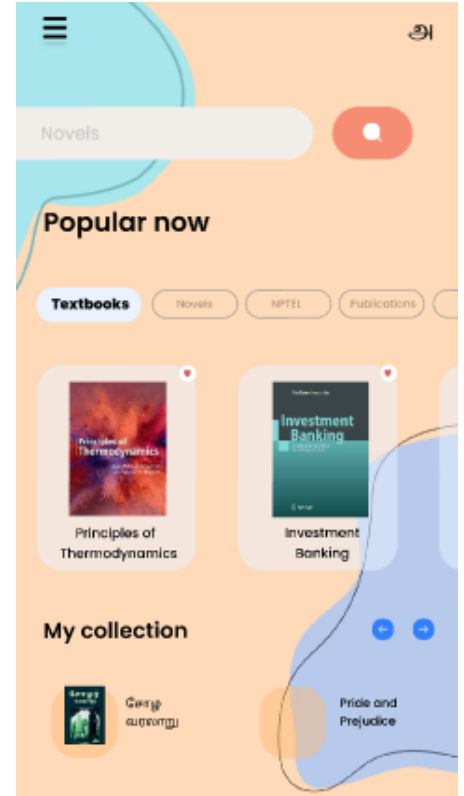
- Legal Aid Chatbot - Our most unique feature is the chatbot. This chatbot will answer your basic legal queries and suggest lawyers based on the domain and location. All it needs is a simple prompt. This chatbot has voice assistance as well.
- Dashboard - An interactive dashboard that keeps a track of the progress of the case including basic data and important court dates
- Parole & Bail application - All UTPs are eligible to apply for parole but due to lack of access to a lawyer and tedious parole procedures, they aren't able to get through with it. Our e-filing feature helps digitalise the whole process and avoid intermediaries.
- Digital Library - A portal consisting of a wide variety of educational resources including textbooks, articles, papers and videos to provide free access to learning resources



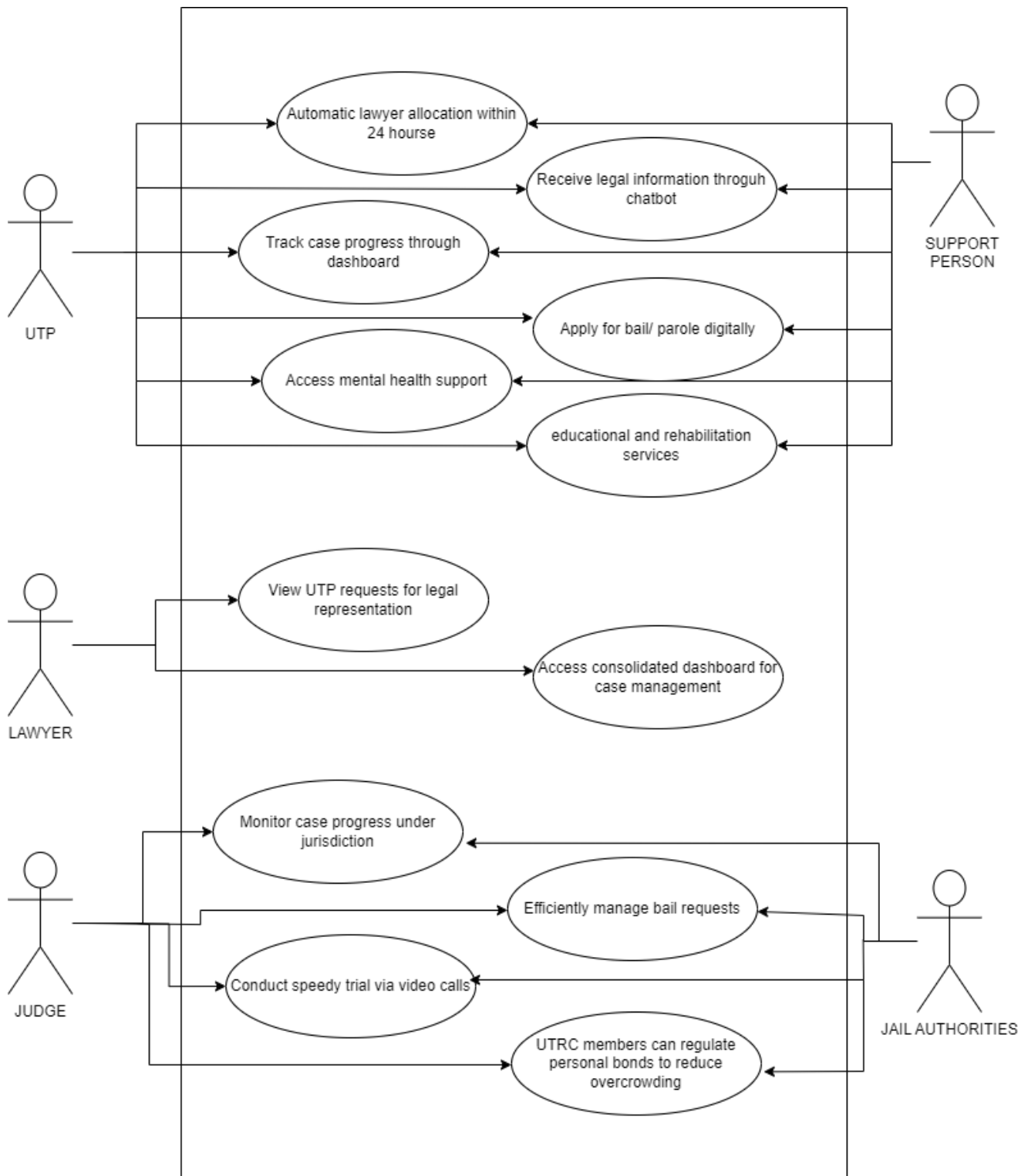
- Rehabilitation - A portal which further contains 3 features
 1. Volunteering services - list of volunteering opportunities for which under-trial prisoners can register
 2. Therapist Support - Under-trial prisoners can access their allotted therapist and schedule appointments
 3. Mental Well-Being Library - A portal with mental health podcasts and meditation playlists to help with anxiety and other psychological disorders

E-Vakheel Admin

- Video conferencing - In case the accused is a high profile criminal, or has extremely dangerous health conditions, they might not be able to attend court sessions due to which the process gets delayed. To deal with this, jail authorities can set up video conference appointments. This can also be used for small cases which need not even need court appointments and can be solved over a video conference itself.
- Periodic Review of UTPs - The UTRC has the power to release UTPs if they've served half the sentence of the crime they've been accused of. Our app enables the committee to oversee the time these prisoners spend in prison
- Language - our app is currently available in both Hindi and Tamizh, in addition to English and will be made available in all regional languages



Use Case Diagram



Conclusion:

The Government of India aspires to digitally transform the judicial system within the next 25 years and we hope our application plays a pivotal role in the transition. Harnessing technology's potential is the key to solving societal issues. This endeavor aims to ensure that the expression "justice delayed is justice denied" becomes a relic of the past.